WONDER DAILY

A Kitchen Sponge

A question full of holes

Little Wonderer peered through a magnifier at a kitchen sponge. A sponge is a soft material that can take in water.

Water finds a way

Big dipped the sponge into a shallow dish. Its lower edge grew darker. Water clung to the sponge's walls and crept into narrow gaps.

A squeeze into the cup

Big lifted the sponge over an empty cup. "Where is the water now?" asked Little. Big gave a gentle squeeze: a press from both sides.

Two little spills

Next they compared two same-size pieces. One was bone-dry; the other was damp, with a little water already inside.

Open again

Big let go after another squeeze. The sponge began to spring back, returning to its open shape. Its spaces opened too, ready to take in water again.

A question to keep

"Is our sponge an animal?" Little asked. "Sea sponges are simple animals," said Big.

Make a little book

1 Fold it into 8 boxes. Open it flat.

2 Fold short end to short end. Cut the thick line. Open it.

3 Fold the long way, pictures out. Push the ends in.

4 Fold into a book. Page 1 goes on the front!